

Chemical bonding & hybridisation — Issue #33 candidate:

Source questions

Q1 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Electron-domain geometry versus molecular shape

Concept difficulty: Medium concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Domain count before hybrid label

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

BF₃ and NH₃ each have three sigma bonds to the central atom. BF₃ has no central lone pair; NH₃ has one. Explain why three

Representation

sigma bonds alone cannot determine the same central hybridisation and molecular shape for both.

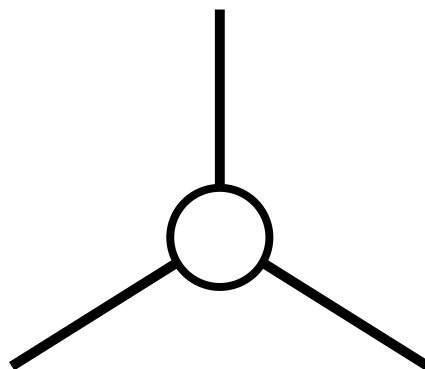
Conditions

- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Common wrong route · open if you want a warning

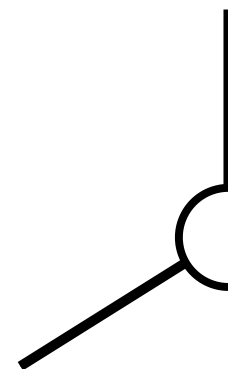


Count directions / regions first



3 domain directions

Domain directions



4 domain directions

Need a hint? · guided support



Need the concept again?

Electron-domain geometry versus molecular shape

Q2 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

Concept difficulty: Hard concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Sigma/pi orbital allocation

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

For $\text{H}_2\text{C}=\text{O}$, assign the carbon hybridisation, count the sigma and pi components of the $\text{C}=\text{O}$ bond, and identify the carbon orbital left available for the pi component. Keep electron-domain counting separate from counting shared electron pairs.

Conditions

- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape

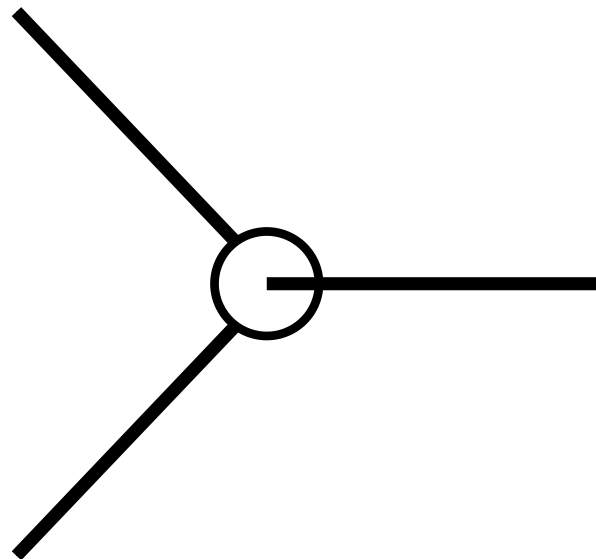
Representation

alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Common wrong route · open if you want a warning

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Stage 1 — sigma-direction frame in the mol



page = molecular plane

Sigma-direction frame

Need a hint? · guided support

+

Need the concept again?

Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

Q3 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

Concept difficulty: Hard concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Sigma/pi orbital allocation

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

Ethene is $\text{H}_2\text{C}=\text{CH}_2$. Translate this Lewis representation into a qualitative orbital-overlap diagram showing the C–C sigma framework, the two unhybridised carbon p orbitals and their side-on overlap. Label

Representation

which directions are in the molecular plane and which are perpendicular to it.

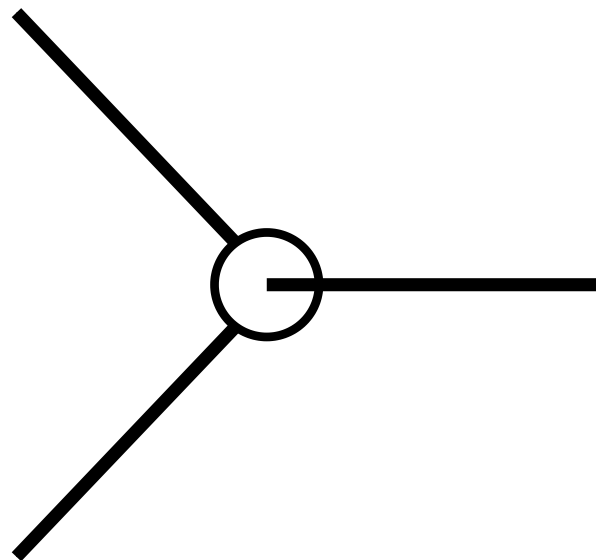
Conditions

- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Common wrong route · open if you want a warning

+

Stage 1 — sigma-direction frame in the mol



page = molecular plane

Sigma-direction frame

Need a hint? · guided support

+

Need the concept again?

Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

COMPETITION TRANSFER

Close an orbital inventory under a changed local description

Original transfer task; not claimed as an official exam/PYQ item.

A neutral carbon centre is described by three coplanar sigma-bond directions and one perpendicular p-orbital participation. Without using a memorised molecule name, give an orbital-job inventory and state one check that would expose double-counting.

Q4 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

Concept difficulty: Hard concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Sigma/pi orbital allocation

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

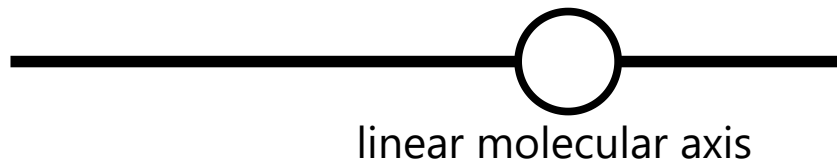
For CO₂, connect the central-carbon Lewis domain count to its hybrid-orbital model, the number of remaining carbon p orbitals and the sigma/pi composition of its two C=O bonds. Explain how these pieces fit one consistent linear arrangement.

Conditions

- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Representation

Stage 1 — two opposite domain / sigma direction



Linear sigma axis

Need a hint? · guided support

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Common wrong route · open if you want a warning

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Need the concept again?

Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

Q5 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Domain count before hybridisation label

Concept difficulty: Medium concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Domain count before hybrid label

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

Consider the claim: 'Any central atom with three sigma bonds must be sp^2 .' Given BF_3 : three B–F sigma bonds, zero boron lone pairs, planar; NH_3 : three N–H sigma bonds, one nitrogen lone pair, pyramidal. Decide whether these observations

Representation

support the claim, give the decisive warrant, and state a more defensible introductory rule. Explain what the shape observations alone do not prove about orbitals.

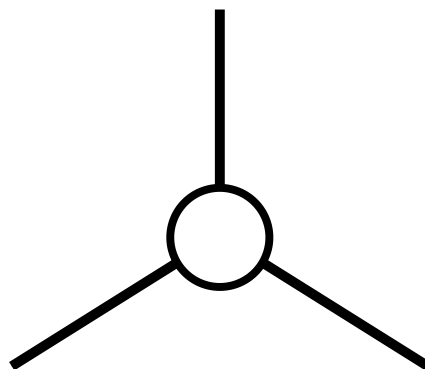
Conditions

- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Common wrong route • open if you want a warning

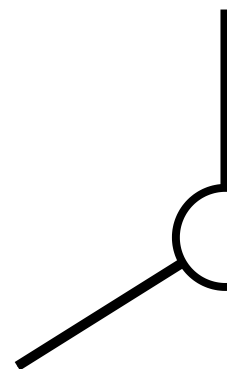


Count directions / regions first



3 domain directions

Domain directions



4 domains

Need a hint? • guided support



Need the concept again?

Domain count before hybridisation label

Q6 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Domain count before hybridisation label

Concept difficulty: Medium concept

Question difficulty: Direct application

Family: Domain count before hybrid label

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

In CH₃F, carbon has three C–H single bonds and one C–F single bond. Assign its introductory local hybridisation and explain why the number of electron-domain directions is unchanged from CH₄ even though the attached atoms are different. Do not assume all bond properties are identical.

Need a hint? · guided support

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Need the concept again?

Domain count before hybridisation label

Conditions

- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape

alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Common wrong route · open if you want a warning

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Q7 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

Concept difficulty: Hard concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Sigma/pi orbital allocation

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

HCN is represented as $\text{H}-\text{C}\equiv\text{N}$ with a lone pair on nitrogen. Assign the introductory

Representation

hybridisation at carbon and nitrogen, and count the sigma and pi components of the $\text{C}\equiv\text{N}$ bond. Explain how the local domain count is compatible with those components.

Conditions

- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Common wrong route • open if you want a warning

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Stage 1 — two opposite domain / sigma direction



linear molecular axis

Linear sigma axis

Need a hint? • guided support

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Need the concept again?

Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

Q8 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Electron-domain geometry versus molecular shape

Concept difficulty: Medium concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Electron-domain geometry versus molecular shape

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

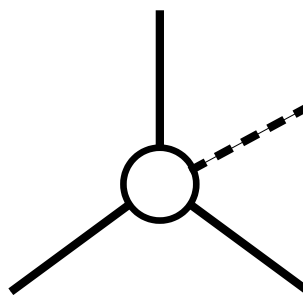
For methylamine, $\text{CH}_3\text{-NH}_2$, carbon has four single bonds and nitrogen has three single bonds plus a lone pair. Compare the introductory local hybridisation and arrangement of bonded atoms at carbon and nitrogen. Explain why the same hybridisation label does not require identical molecular shapes.

Conditions

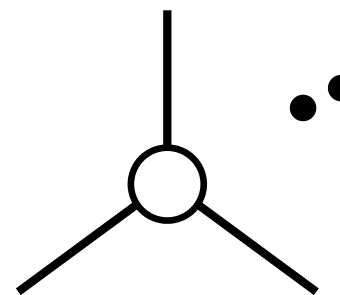
- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the

Representation

Same four-domain scaffold



4 bond positions



3 bonds + 1 lone pair



2 bor

Occupancy cases

question; do not treat molecular shape alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Need a hint? · guided support

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Need the concept again?

Electron-domain geometry versus molecular shape

Common wrong route · open if you want a warning

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Q9 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

Concept difficulty: Hard concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Sigma/pi orbital allocation

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

Representation

A carbon centre has three sigma-bond directions, no lone pair, and participates in one pi bond. Translate this description into a qualitative local orbital arrangement and check that the orbitals used in the sigma and pi parts have not been counted twice.

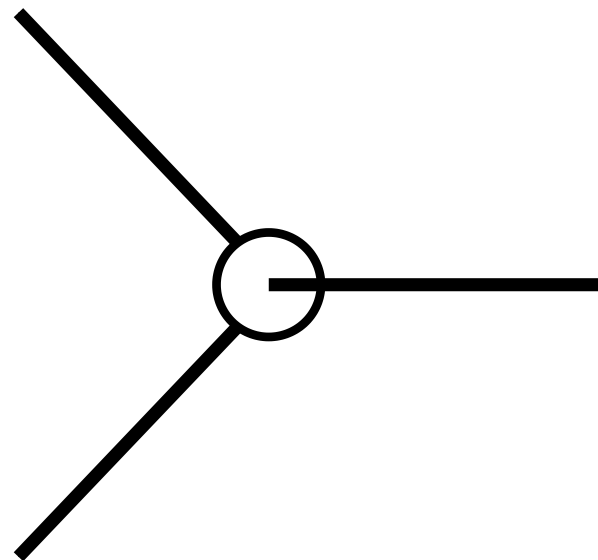
Conditions

- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Common wrong route · open if you want a warning

+

Stage 1 — sigma-direction frame in the mol



page = molecular plane

Sigma-direction frame

Need a hint? · guided support

+

Need the concept again?

Sigma/pi orbital inventory without double-counting

COMPETITION TRANSFER

Close an orbital inventory under a changed local description

Original transfer task; not claimed as an official exam/PYQ item.

A neutral carbon centre is described by three coplanar sigma-bond directions and one perpendicular p-orbital participation. Without using a memorised molecule name, give an orbital-job inventory and state one check that would expose double-counting.

Q10 Owner-supplied question, verbatim · coordinator/AI-drafted benchmark

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Chemical bonding and hybridisation

Concept: Electron-domain geometry versus molecular shape

Concept difficulty: Medium concept

Question difficulty: Connected reasoning

Family: Electron-domain geometry versus molecular shape

Question type: Constructed response

Source: Owner-supplied question

Provenance: Owner-supplied question

ATTEMPT FIRST

A student says, 'If the electron-domain geometry is tetrahedral, the atoms must form a tetrahedral molecular shape.'

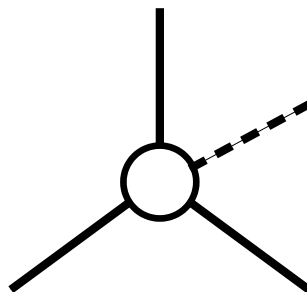
Evaluate the statement using CH_4 , NH_3 and H_2O , with their respective central lone-pair counts of zero, one and two.

Conditions

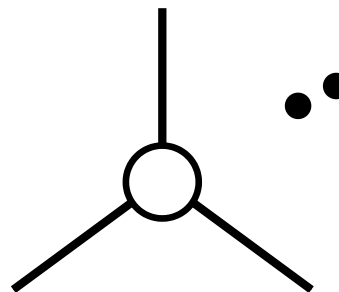
- Use the bounded introductory localized hybrid-orbital model requested by the question; do not treat molecular shape alone as direct measurement of orbital mixing.

Representation

Same four-domain scaffold



4 bond positions



3 bonds + 1 lone pair



2 bor

Occupancy cases

Need a hint? · guided support

+

Common wrong route · open if you want a warning

+

Need the concept again?

Electron-domain geometry versus molecular shape

COMPETITION TRANSFER

Hold domain geometry fixed while changing atom occupancy

Original transfer task; not claimed as an official exam/PYQ item.

A four-domain centre is changed from four bonds to two bonds plus two lone pairs without changing the total domain count. Explain which geometry description is preserved and which atom-only description must be reconsidered.